

and summarises your data. You can then use the report to analyse the data—for example, make comparisons, detect patterns and relationships, and analyse trends.

3.7.1.1 Summarise And Analyse Your Data

To see the ‘big picture’ of your data, use a ‘PivotTable’ report to summarise and analyse the data. Control how Excel summarises the data—by sum, average, or count—without entering a single formula.

3.7.1.2 Add Or Remove Data

Not quite enough information in your ‘PivotTable’ report? For example, maybe you want to include sales figures broken down by salesperson. You can easily add or remove categories of data.

3.7.1.3 Quickly Rearrange The Layout

Not satisfied with the layout of your ‘PivotTable’ report? For example, maybe you’d prefer to display the salesperson information in rows instead of in columns. The interactive nature of your PivotTable report lets you literally turn the table: you can easily move (or ‘pivot’) the rows and columns to view different summaries of the data.

Are there other reasons to use page fields? If your ‘PivotTable’ report contains many fields, you can use page fields to keep your report compact and readable. Or, if you’re retrieving data from a large, external non-OLAP (Online Analytical Processing) database, use page fields to limit the amount of data retrieved at a time. That way, you can avoid long waits and memory problems.

3.7.1.4 Show Just The Details You Want

Want to zero in on specific details in a PivotTable report? You can display or hide items in a row or column—for example, specific products or salespersons. You can also display or hide details about items in row or column.

3.7.2 Prepare The Data For The PivotTable Report

Before you begin, it’s a good idea to make sure your data is well organised and ready to go.